AAE 200: Sophomore Seminar
[26216-001]
Course Syllabus
Asynchronous Online

1 Course Description

This seminar is designed to initiate the personal and professional development of sophomore aerospace engineering students through a structured, longitudinal framework. The course uses a personalized, choice-based system where students identify their unique strengths and areas for improvement through initial skills assessments. Students begin the first phase of an **Individual Development Plan (IDP)**, breaking down their objectives into actionable goals. The curriculum is synchronized with the key campus events academic decision points to provide timely guidance on obtaining jobs/internship/research opportunities and selecting academic specializations.

The only pre-requisite for this course is sophomore standing or above in AAE. The schedule is **tentative;** we will update the syllabus and send announcements if/when something changes about the schedule. The Instructional Modality for this course is **Asynchronous-Online. Two tasks are due every week by Sunday 11:59 pm (except for the first and the last weeks where only one task is due). Tasks will be assigned through Brightspace and submitted through gradescope**.

Week	Individual Development Plan (IDP)	Skills Development
1	Know Yourself (Skills Assessment) and Learning Plan Checklist	
2	Iteration 1 (add short-term goals)	Getting Job/Internship/Research
3	Iteration 2 (add intermediate-term goals)	Management
4	Iteration 3 (add long-term goals)	Leadership and Mentorship
5	Peer evaluation	Professionalism
6	Peer feedback edits	Ethics
7	Iteration 4 (final version) and reflection	Intercultural Collaboration
8	*No task*	Learn About AAE

2 Learning Outcomes

- Establish personal and professional goals in a multi-year Individual Development Plan.
- Construct job seeking materials such as resumes, elevator pitches, and LinkedIn profiles from scratch and make it ATS-compliant to increase likelihood of reaching a recruiter;
- Identify specific stressors and the corresponding resources available for mental health management
- Apply time management strategies to balance the demands of academics with personal tasks.
- Formulate a strategic plan for developing a successful mentoring relationship, both as mentee and as mentor
- Critically assess the thoughtful use of generative AI in writing to ensure academic integrity

and professional authenticity
- Identify the basic tenets of intellectual property and its importance in protecting engineering innovations
- Apply design principles to format presentation slides to effectively communicate information.
- Rank competing ethical priorities to determine the most critical course of action in engineering scenarios.
- Apply strategies for communicating across cultures to navigate potential misunderstandings in multi-disciplinary or international engineering teams.
- Identify suitable AAE specializations based on interests.

3 Earning a 'Satisfactory' Grade

- This 0-credit course is graded as 'satisfactory' ('S') or 'unsatisfactory' ('U').
- There is a total of 14 tasks (7 IDP tasks and 7 skills development tasks). Each task is worth 10 points. Therefore, there are a total of 140 points.
- To earn a satisfactory (S) grade in the course, you must fulfill the following two requirements:
    - You must earn a minimum of 6 points in each task.
    - You must earn at least 120 points altogether in the course.

3.1 Assignment Quality

We expect that you will put forth a reasonable amount of effort on the weekly assignments. These assignments are designed to take about 1 hour per week on average, and we hope that you will find them beneficial to helping you succeed as an aerospace engineering student at Purdue.

Please make sure to follow all instructions on completing and submitting the assignments. Assignments that do not follow all instructions or are not submitted correctly by the deadline may not be graded, and you will not receive the corresponding participation point.

4 Learning Resources

There is no required textbook for this course. All course materials will be posted on Brightspace and tasks will be submitted on Gradescope. There are no prerequisites for this course, other than being an AAE student with at least sophomore standing.

5 How to Succeed in this Course

To succeed in this course, check Brightspace on class days when new material is posted—set up a calendar notification to make sure you do not forget to do so. You will have 1 brief assignment per week. Don't wait until the last day to begin the assignments. If you encounter a problem with the assignments or something about the course procedures is not clear, you can reach out to the TA via email.

6 Attendance/Late Work Policy

This course is conducted in an asynchronous-online format. There will be no in-person meetings for the course. As such, there is no required attendance component. Students are expected to complete the tasks and earn the minimum points as outlined in section 3 of this syllabus.

All tasks must be submitted to Gradescope by Sunday 11:59 pm (on the corresponding dates listed on Brightspace). **A 1-point deduction will be applied to tasks submitted within 24 hours of the deadline. Tasks submitted more than 24 hours after the deadline may not be accepted and will require TA approval, along with a 2-point deduction.** Exceptions may be made on a case-by-case basis and for circumstances such as medically related absences, grief/bereavement, jury/military duties, etc. Please contact the TA for any questions on assignment deadlines/submissions.